

Appendix 4.6.2B: Application for Advancement and/or Tenure

CALDWELL UNIVERSITY

Caldwell, New Jersey

APPLICATION FOR: ADVANCEMENT ✓ TENURE _____

Name: **Vladislav D. Veksler, Ph.D.**

Department: Computer Science & Information Systems

Present Rank: Assistant Professor

Date of Appointment: January 2022

Rank Applied For: Associate Professor

To Become Effective: January 2027

QUANTITATIVE CRITERIA

I. EDUCATIONAL HISTORY

A. Degrees:

<u>Undergraduate</u>	<u>Institution</u>	<u>Date</u>
B.A. Computer Science & Psychology	Rutgers University	May 1999
<u>Graduate</u>	<u>Institution</u>	<u>Date</u>
M.S. Cognitive Science	Rensselaer Polytechnic Institute	May 2006
<u>Graduate</u>	<u>Institution</u>	<u>Date</u>
Ph.D. Cognitive Science	Rensselaer Polytechnic Institute	May 2009

B. Academic Honors Received:

<u>Description</u>	<u>Institution</u>	<u>Date</u>
Alvin R. Calman Endowed Chair	Caldwell University	2025
National Research Council Fellowship	U.S. Air Force Research Lab	2011
Dean Harry J. Carman Fellowship	Rensselaer Polytechnic Institute	2008
Graduated with Honors	Rutgers University	1999

C. Academic Courses Beyond Last Degree (current and past; include date): None

D. Non-Academic Training Programs and Professional Development:

- **2025-2026:**
 - Learning & Development: Vite, JS libraries (CodeMirror 6), web standards (WebLLM, new CSS selector, unicode regex), prompt engineering, local LLMs, MCP.
 - Conferences & Workshops: 41st annual conference of the Consortium for Computing Sciences in Colleges Eastern Region (2025), 30th annual conference of the Consortium for Computing Sciences in Colleges Northeast Region (2026), Inside Higher Ed Workshop: Academic Integrity Under Fire (2026), Rethinking Assessment in the Age of Generative AI (2026), Navigating Faculty Development Grants (2026), AI Tools for Teaching, Research, and Productivity (Faculty Forum) (2026), several other AI-related online workshops/lectures and podcasts.
- **2024-2025:**
 - Learning & Development: HTMX, React/babel, nicegui, steamlit, JS libraries (codemirror, monaco), web components, new web standards, WASM/WASI.
 - Workshops/Lectures: Several AI-related online workshops/lectures.
- **2023-2024:**
 - Learning & Development: Web development technologies (HTML, CSS, JavaScript, GCP/Firebase), Visual Studio Code extension API, Impact of AI on education.
 - Conference/Workshop attendance: Caldwell University AI Workshop series (2024), 16th International Conference on Brain Informatics (BI 2023), CIC Funding the Future Workshop (2024), CISE CAREER NSF Workshop (2024).
- **2022-2023:**
 - Learning & Development: Python libraries (Kivy, Pandas), ChatGPT prompt exploration, transformer network architecture.
 - Conference/Workshop attendance: 2022 ACT-R Workshop, 15th Annual AGI Conference (AGI-22), EXPAND AI virtual office hours.
- **2021-2022:**
 - Learning & Development: Python frameworks, Jupyter, JavaFX, Unity.
- **2009-2021:**
 - Conferences/Workshops: 17th Annual Meeting of the International Conference on Cognitive Modelling (ICCM 2019), 16th Annual Meeting of the International Conference on Cognitive Modelling (ICCM 2018)., Twenty-Second Annual ACT-R Workshop, Thirteenth International Conference of Cognitive Modeling, 22nd Behavior Representation in Modeling & Simulation (BRIMS) Conference, 34th Annual Meeting of the Cognitive Science Society (CogSci2012), 2nd International Conference on Biologically Inspired Cognitive Architectures (BICA 2011).

II. PROFESSIONAL HISTORY

A. Current and past experience in professions other than teaching (business, industry, government, religion, etc.)

(2014 – 2022) DCS Corp, U.S. Army Research Lab / CCDC Data & Analysis Center, Aberdeen, MD
Researcher Scientist
(2011 – 2014) U.S. Air Force Research Laboratory, Human Effectiveness Directorate, WPAFB, OH
Post-doctoral Research Fellow (Advisor: Kevin A. Gluck)
(2002 – 2003) Freelance, Remote
Software Engineer
(1998 – 2001) Telcordia Technologies, SAIC, Piscataway, NJ and Morristown, NJ
Software Engineer
(1997) American ReInsurance, Princeton, NJ
Programmer
(1995 – 1997) GE/RCA Licensing, Princeton, NJ
Web Development and PC-Network Support

B. Teaching experience prior to coming to Caldwell University:

(2020 – 2022) Bloomfield College, Bloomfield, NJ
Adjunct Professor of Computer Science
(2009 – 2011) Rensselaer Polytechnic Institute, Troy, NY
Lecturer

C. Date of first appointment to Caldwell University Faculty:
Assistant Professor January 2022

D. Teaching Experience at Caldwell University: Courses Taught:

I have taught the full range of Computer Science courses from 100 to 400 -level courses, as well as First-Year Seminar, and Honors Thesis.

I have taken on voluntary overload every full academic year that I have taught at Caldwell University, as well as several large (30+) student sections.

- CS 195 Computer Programming I: Fall 2022, Fall 2023, Fall 2024, Fall 2025
- CS 196 Computer Programming II: Spring 2022, Spring 2023, Spring 2024, Spring 2025, Spring 2026
- CS 197 Computer Programming Accelerated: Spring 2025
- CS 219 Business Spreadsheets: Spring 2022
- CS 230 Front-End Web Development: Fall 2022, Fall 2023, Fall 2024
- CS 240 Windows Programming: Summer 2024
- CS 242 UI/UX Human-Centered Design: Spring 2023, Spring 2024, Spring 2025, Spring 2026
- CS 355 Full-Stack Web Development: Summer 2022, Spring 2023, Spring 2024, Spring 2025, Spring 2026

- CS 420 Artificial Intelligence: Fall 2022, Fall 2023, Fall 2024, Spring 2025, Fall 2025
- CS 450 Software Engineering Capstone: Fall 2022, Spring 2025, Fall 2025, Spring 2026
- CS 487/489/490 Field Internship: Summer 2023, Fall 2023, Spring 2024, Summer 2024, Fall 2024, Summer 2025, Fall 2025, Winter 2026, Spring 2026
- CS 491 Research in Computer Science I: Spring 2023, Fall 2023, Spring 2024, Fall 2024, Spring 2025, Fall 2025
- CS 492 Research in Computer Science II: Fall 2023, Spring 2024, Fall 2024, Spring 2025
- CS 299/499 Independent Study: Fall 2023, Spring 2024, Fall 2024, Spring 2025, Fall 2025, Spring 2026
- FS 189 First-Year Seminar: Fall 2023, Spring 2024, Fall 2024, Spring 2025, Fall 2025
- HP 405 Honors Project: Fall 2023, Spring 2024, Fall 2024, Spring 2025, Fall 2025, Spring 2026
- BU 487 Field Internship: Fall 2023

E. Participation in departmental activities:

- Led comprehensive curriculum modernization, including redesigning major/minor requirements, updating prerequisites, and transitioning core programming sequences (CS 195/196) from Java to Python.
- Developed numerous new undergraduate and graduate courses (e.g., CS 150, CS 242, CS 415, CS 491/492, CS 197, and multiple courses for the MS in Computer Science and STEM MBA programs).
- Spearheaded the development of new interdisciplinary programs, including the Human-Computer Interaction minor, MS in Computer Science, and STEM MBA.
- Created and standardized Master Courses in Blackboard for introductory CS sequences to support adjunct faculty.
- Initiated infrastructure improvements, including redesigning classroom layouts (e.g., RAY207) to facilitate collaborative learning environments.
- Evaluated 3 CS adjunct faculty.
- Spearheaded CS course equivalency work for all transfer students since 2022.
- Served as mentor for new full-time faculty member (Mohamed Gebril).
- Developed a newsletter website for SBCS in 2022 (website was sunset in 2025).

F. Administrative and/or supervisory services (Chair of Department, Directorship of Program, Supervisor of Student Teaching, etc.):

- Co-director of the Faculty Development Committee (06/2024 - 05/2026)
- Co-director of the Teaching & Learning Center (06/2024 - 05/2026)
- Co-founder and co-director of C-STEM Laboratories (10/2022 - present)
- Founder and director of CogAI Research Laboratory (01/2022 - present)
- Member of the Institutional Review Board (01/2022 - present)
- Chair of the Dean of Arts & Sciences Search Committee
- Served on multiple faculty hire search committees: two CS positions, Graphics Design, and Psychology
- Liaison for Computer Science teaching assistants (08/2022 - present)

G. Current employment at other Academic Institutions: None

QUALITATIVE CRITERIA

I. Teaching Effectiveness (4.5.1.1.1):

As stated in the Faculty Handbook: “Ability as a teacher and the ability to provide an atmosphere in which students can learn are considered foremost among the qualitative criteria for advancement since the primary function of Caldwell University is to provide a liberal arts education for students. The criteria to be evaluated are the quality of curriculum organization, delivery, and classroom pedagogy, alignment of course material with course goals, student engagement in the class, methods of assessing student learning, daily preparation for class work, and rapport with students. Evidence for effectiveness in teaching can include, but is not limited to, sample syllabi and course assignments, original learning aids (such as PowerPoints, videos, handouts, activities, etc.), teaching observations, student feedback (particularly Student Opinion Reports), self-assessments, and previous evaluations of teaching ability (particularly the Chair/Associate Dean Annual Review of Non-Tenured Faculty).”

Discuss and provide concrete evidence as to how you have satisfied these criteria.

I have two primary goals in teaching. The first is to inspire a passion and enthusiasm for Computer Science (CS), technology, and problem-solving among my students. The second is to expose students to key foundational concepts in CS and build a solid grounding for my students to become life-long learners. In addition to the goals above, I have several secondary goals as an instructor:

- to let my students know that they matter, that I like them, and that I am there for them
- to provide equitable opportunities for my students according to each student’s individual needs, capabilities, and drive
- to emphasize resume-building, interview preparation, and general career-readiness
- to emphasize speaking and presentation skills in courses that allow for this
- to turn my students into well-rounded professionals and human beings

I refer to the bulleted goals above as “secondary” not because these are less important than my primary goals, but rather because they are founded in and naturally stem from my two primary teaching objectives.

I have demonstrated a high level of effectiveness in teaching and developing a wide variety of courses that span the entire Computer Science curriculum, from foundational 100-level introductory classes to advanced 400-level senior requirements. My teaching portfolio includes core sequences such as Computer Programming I and II, as well as specialized upper-level courses like Artificial Intelligence, UI/UX Human-Centered Design, and the Software Engineering Capstone. I have also been deeply involved in the First-Year Student Seminar, helping incoming students transition to university life. Beyond mere instruction, I led the major effort to modernize the curriculum by transitioning our core programming sequence from Java to Python to better prepare students for modern industry expectations. I have also developed several

new courses (more detail under Scholarship section) and authored master courses on Blackboard for foundational classes to ensure instructional consistency and rigor across all sections.

My pedagogical approach is centered on using current and relevant technology, and I frequently develop my own software solutions when existing options do not meet the specific needs of my students. I have integrated Jupyter Notebooks into my teaching, which allows me to present and run live computer code directly within my lecture notes, a technique that significantly enhances procedural learning. To improve classroom management and academic integrity, I designed and developed several applications, including LectureSeats for multi-factor attendance tracking and LectureTest for secure, proctored coding examinations (this developed technology is also used now by other Caldwell instructors in departments such as Business and Psychology). By using tools like Figma for design and VS Code for development, I ensure that my students are working with the same professional environments they will encounter in their careers.

I have been highly effective in adapting and updating my course structures and grading schemas to meet evolving challenges, particularly in response to the rise of generative AI. Recognizing that standard assignments can now be easily automated, I rebalanced my grading structure so that high-stakes, proctored in-class assessments make up the vast majority of the final grade. I now use take-home assignments primarily as low-stakes preparation for these proctored tests rather than as the primary evidence of learning. This shift ensures that I can accurately gauge a student's true code-writing abilities. Furthermore, I have introduced "sprint-based" project management in courses like Programming II, requiring frequent code commits via Git and GitHub so that I can inspect the progress of student work over time rather than just the final product.

The effectiveness of my teaching is consistently validated by my peer observers, who highlight my ability to maintain high engagement even in large lecture settings. During a review of my Computer Programming II course, Dr. Ruth DeBar noted that my "animation and rapport with the students made the large lecture hall feel like a small and intimate class" and that my "passion for the topic and for student success was clear." She also observed my innovative use of technology for attendance and my commitment to confirming student understanding before moving to new concepts. Similarly, Dr. Kenneth Reeve praised my ability to "present and run computer code directly in [my] lecture notes" and commended my proactive efforts to address academic integrity in the age of AI, describing me as a "wonderful asset to the University, [my] students, and [my] discipline."

My teaching success is further evidenced by exceptional student engagement and near-perfect Student Opinion Report (SOR) ratings, which average 4.9 out of 5.0 across all courses. Additionally, students frequently go beyond the syllabus requirements to ask complex questions, reflecting a deep interest in the material. My commitment to student success is a common theme in their feedback, as seen in the following representative comments:

Professor Vlad is an outstanding teacher who knows what he is doing and **always offers help** • He makes everything easy to understand and makes sure every student is on the same page • He made this complicated course too easy • Incredibly cool and **constantly available** to assist students who run into problems while coding • Professor Veksler goes **above and beyond** to make sure we learn everything we need to • He helps to know many

things about college life and more • Very professional and knowledgeable - He cares about your well being and wants to see you succeed • Professor Vlad is very charming and a pro at attention grabbing • He has an amazing knowledge about computer science best part is he knows how to share his knowledge • Amazing Lectures, Lots of Experience, Understanding and easily accessible for any Questions • He is very enthusiastic about teaching and has the ability to generate excitement in students • He's the best prof I've ever had!! • Vlad is among the best professor I came across with • Teaching style by going through every chapter with perfect explanation • Genuinely wants students to learn • The course was very well-organized; I was able to learn so much • Interactive and engaging with current subject topics and updates • He is unique and engaging • The instructor replies quickly to emails and concerns of students • He used class time wisely and always made sure he helped everyone and was very approachable and understanding • The instructor made sure that all students did the work giving opportunities to get help on assignments • 1. Very interactive 2. Very Knowledgeable about the field of instruction 3. Speaks clearly 4. Encourages questions in class. 5. Assignments are clearly link with lessons • Adapts his teaching to the student's needs • He is understanding of students and gives time to each and every students. I was once absent in the class and he made sure to stay later the class to go over the materials I missed • Organized, well spoken, caring • The instructor is very good at explaining concepts that seem to be difficult to understand at first. He is very good at breaking things down into pieces that are easy to understand, and his examples and demos/labs are always very informative • Professor Veksler goes above and beyond to make sure we learn everything we need to. He has an amazing knowledge about computer science best part is he knows how to share his knowledge. To top it all, he has a great sense humor. His class is something that I always look up to. • Taking time out of class to help students, even with things not entirely related to course work, enthusiasm • He is clear and concise. Explains course materials very efficiently. • Dr veksler is an amazing professor. His teaching style is fun, energetic and he makes his point very clear. He is also very reachable outside of class to help with assignments or projects. • Professor Vlad is awesome. He teaches everything in depth, and explains the content around it. He sets the context properly and shows examples of what he is talking about. He also highlights specific words that might come up in tech interviews later. The best thing about him is that he makes all the resources available to the students even after the academic session is over. He is also very well spoken and always ready to help. • Prof V. is lively and great! He's always happy to help, make time for students, and you can tell he loves what he does.

On a final note, I am grateful to have been nominated by my students for the **Excellence in Teaching Award** five years running (2022, 2023, 2024, 2025, 2026).

II. Academic Advising and Mentoring (4.5.1.1.2)

As stated in the Faculty Handbook: “Effectiveness in academic advising and mentoring is an important instrument of evaluation since the university is dedicated to the personal development of each student. One of Caldwell’s goals is to provide students with aid and direction through the

services of a dedicated and competent faculty and, when deemed necessary, through referrals to appropriate student services personnel. The criteria to be evaluated are availability to students, effectiveness in advising students in connection with their class work, degree programs, internships, and career plans, and mentoring of students outside of class to assist them with their academic work. Work with student clubs is not part of this criterion, but falls under service. Evidence of effectiveness in advising can include, but is not limited to, self-assessments, student feedback (ex. emails), and the Chair/Associate Dean annual evaluation report and other feedback.”

Discuss and provide concrete evidence as to how you have satisfied these criteria.

Since joining the Caldwell University faculty in January 2022, I have served as a dedicated academic advisor to a large volume of Computer Science, CIS, and Marketing students, typically maintaining a roster of 40–50+ advisees annually. My approach to advising and mentorship is holistic, extending beyond course scheduling and degree progression to include career readiness, internship placement, and professional development. I actively guide students in navigating complex graduation constraints while ensuring they are prepared for the demands of the modern technology industry.

A significant component of my mentorship involves supporting students in their long-term aspirations. As a part of this commitment I have served as a First-Year Seminar instructor, and I regularly serve as an advisor for student internships. A not-insignificant portion of my time is dedicated to writing recommendation letters; since joining Caldwell, I have written and submitted approximately 150-200 letters to support students applying for scholarships, summer research programs, fellowships, graduate schools, and career opportunities. This commitment ensures that my students remain competitive candidates for top-tier programs and positions.

My research mentorship is a cornerstone of my interactions with students. I strongly believe that student research participation is a transformative catalyst that gives students a distinct advantage over those who do not engage in such work or attend college, serving as a unique pathway for their growth as individuals, professionals, and thinkers, and acting as one of the best foundations for successful graduate studies. As the founder and director of the CogAI Research Laboratory and co-founder of the C-STEM Laboratories, I have mentored dozens of undergraduate researchers annually—ranging from 5–10 students during the semester to up to 18 during the summer. I guide these students through every phase of the research process, from writing competitive proposals (with dozens of STEM Advance Summer Research proposals accepted under my guidance) to the development of complex projects, resulting in numerous peer-reviewed publications/presentations, as well presentations at the annual Caldwell Research Day. Additionally, I have served as an advisor on four Honors Thesis Projects (Anuj Khadka, Dibas Dauliya, Subham Chaudhary, Saurav Ghimire).

Furthermore, I am deeply involved in student life as the advisor for multiple organizations, including the Caldwell Computer Science Club, the Caldwell Robotics Club, and the Google Developers Group. I actively mentor these student leaders in organizing large-scale events, securing funding, and coordinating successful participation in intercollegiate competitions. By fostering these extracurricular opportunities and maintaining an open-door policy, I aim to create

a supportive environment that prepares students to become well-rounded, career-ready professionals.

- **Student-Coauthored Peer-Reviewed Publications and Presentations** (student names in bold):
 - **Poudel, Samarpan** & Veksler, V. D. (2026). Beyond Accuracy: A LIME-Based Comparative Analysis of Custom CNN and Pretrained ResNet50 for Lung Cancer CT Classification. 30th annual conference of the Consortium for Computing Sciences in Colleges, Northeastern Region (CCSCNE). Northampton, MA.
 - 2nd place Best Research Poster Award
 - **Regmi, Satyam**, & Veksler, V. D. (2026). Facial Expression Recognition and Response with Tension Mapping and LLM-Assisted Dialogue. 30th annual conference of the Consortium for Computing Sciences in Colleges, Northeastern Region (CCSCNE). Northampton, MA.
 - **Khadka, Anuj**, & Veksler, V. D. (2026). Robo-Advisors and the Investor Experience. 30th annual conference of the Consortium for Computing Sciences in Colleges, Northeastern Region (CCSCNE). Northampton, MA.
 - Veksler, V. D., Veksler, B. Z., & **Khadka, A.** (2025). Plagiarism Detection and Deterrence Using Behavioral Tracking. *Journal of Computing Sciences in Colleges*, 41(3).
 - **Thapa, K., Adhikari, D.**, & Veksler, V. D. (2025). Evaluating LMS Usability and Accessibility for Students and Instructors. *41st annual conference of the Consortium for Computing Sciences in Colleges, Eastern Region (CCSC Eastern)*. Glenside, PA.
 - **Maharjan, K.** & Veksler, V. D. (2025). Detecting Plagiarism through Visualization of Coding Activity Logs. *41st annual conference of the Consortium for Computing Sciences in Colleges, Eastern Region (CCSC Eastern)*. Glenside, PA.
 - **Mensah, P.** & Veksler, V. D. (2025). A Comparative Analysis of UINL and HTML/CSS for Web Application. *29th annual conference of the Consortium for Computing Sciences in Colleges, Northeastern Region (CCSCNE)*. Brockport, NY.
 - **Sharma, K.** & Veksler, V. D. (2025). Plagiarism detection in Computer Programming assignments using behavior tracking. *29th annual conference of the Consortium for Computing Sciences in Colleges, Northeastern Region (CCSCNE)*. Brockport, NY.
 - **Gedenidze, N.** & Veksler, V. D. (2024). A Layer-Freezing Approach for Reduced Backpropagation Demand. *28th annual conference of the Consortium for Computing Sciences in Colleges, Northeastern Region (CCSCNE)*. Albany, NY.
 - **Salazar, J.** & Veksler, V. D. (2024). Comparing Touch-Based Coding to Traditional Computer Programming Methods. *28th annual conference of the Consortium for Computing Sciences in Colleges, Northeastern Region (CCSCNE)*. Albany, NY.
 - **Khatrri, K., Khadka, S.**, & Veksler, V. D. (2024). ML for Plagiarism Detection in Coding Assignments. *28th annual conference of the Consortium for Computing Sciences in Colleges, Northeastern Region (CCSCNE)*. Albany, NY.

- **Gogitidze, G. & Veksler, V. D. (2024).** Using a GPT with Reinforcement Learning for More Personalized or Targeted Text Generation. *28th annual conference of the Consortium for Computing Sciences in Colleges, Northeastern Region (CCSCNE)*. Albany, NY.
- Veksler, V.D., **Gedenidze, N., & Yadav, R. (2023).** Visual Cortex Doesn't Change, Why should Convolutional Layers? *The 16th International Conference on Brain Informatics*. Hoboken, NJ, USA.
- **Gedenidze, N. & Veksler, V. D. (2023).** Backpropagation is expensive. Is it necessary? *27th annual conference of the Consortium for Computing Sciences in Colleges, Northeastern Region (CCSCNE)*. Ithaca, NY.
- **Computing Competitions:** I mentor and support student leaders in organizing events and coordinating travel and participation in intercollegiate competitions.
 - Caldwell University hosted competitions
 - RoboCup 2024; 25 competitors, large student audience.
 - CougarHacks coding competition 2025; 80 participants; three cash prizes awarded.
 - Intercollegiate coding competitions: Supported students in preparation, travel, and participation in dozens of highly competitive intercollegiate hackathons, often resulting in our students receiving top prizes –
 - 6 first place prizes (Vassar Data Analysis Competition 2023, HackPrinceton 2024, HackRU 2024, HackNYU 2025, HopHacks 2025, Hack@URI 2026)
 - 2 second place prizes (HackNJIT 2024, HopHacks 2024)
 - 1 Top 10 main prize finalist (HackMIT 2025)
 - 1 honorable mention (CalHacks 2025)
- **Caldwell Research & Creative Arts Day:** I have consistently served as a student advisor for the annual Caldwell Research & Creative Arts Day. In the last four years my students have presented 38 posters and demos, with several winning Best-in-Category awards for their innovative work.
 - Bishal Kumar Jaiswal (2026). From Raw Data to Boardroom Reports: An AI-Driven Platform for Business Analysis, Chart Building, and Automated Insights.
 - Akaki Jvarsheishvili (2026). Does a cross-asset validation protocol improve the reliability of single-asset HMM regime transition signals by reducing false positives and minimizing detection lag.
 - Anuj Khadka (2026). Robo Advisors and Investor Experience
 - Satyam Regmi (2026). Facial Expression Recognition and Response with Tension Mapping and LLM-Assisted Dialogue.
 - Kenisha Thapa, Diya Adhikari (2026). Evaluating LMS Usability and Accessibility for Students and Instructors.
 - Pranish Uprety (2026). Flight Path Simulation and Terrain-Aware Navigation System for Mountainous Airspaces.
 - Anuj Khadka (2026). Measuring the Carbon Impact of Algorithm Execution.
 - Subham Chaudhary (2026). Direct Fine-Tuning vs Translate-Then-Classify for Nepali Sentiment Analysis.

- Dibas Dauliya (2026). Evaluating Large Language Models Using the SAT.
- Praniti Aryal, Dibas Dauliya, Diya Adhikari, Saugat Karki (2026). Invest Lab—A Smarter Investment Platform.
- Prashamsa Kharel, Saurav Ghimire, Bijaya B C, Philemon Ativor (2026). UniMarketplace demo.
- Shanya Poudyal, Diogo Santos, Jorge Gonzalez, Pratiush Karki, Samip Udas (2026). NIL app demo.
- Amrisha Yadav, Shovan Raut, Anshuraj Sedai, Subham Chaudhary, Forlinf Amoamah-Antwi (2026). Shadow Boxing: A Real-Time Motion-Controlled Boxing Game demo.
- Nathan Ayele (2025). Empowering Student Builders: How Student-Led Web & AI Projects Can Solve Real Problems.
- Dibas Dauliya (2025). Essential Components: Enhancing Web Development with Reusable, Framework-Agnostic Tools.
- Saurav Ghimire (2025). Python model for predicting road accident hotspots in Nepal.
- Prince Mensah, Christian Severin (2025). Comparative Analysis of UINL and HTML/CSS in Web-based Application Development.
- Krenjila Sharma (2025). Plagiarism detection in Computer Programming assignments using behavior tracking.
- Sujan Thapa (2025). Enhancing College Information Systems Using Retrieval-Augmented Generation.
- Brendan Barbosa, Suman Bista, Eric Ortega, Bivek Kadle, Resha Chettry, Brendan Barbosa (2025). Mindful Motion software demo.
- Hrizu Bhattarai, Ishaq Ansari, Ayush Upreti, Eyad Ahmad, Prince Mensah (2025). Momentum (A Mental Health Social Media demo).
- Ajay Rayamaj, Anjuli KC, Pralosh Rajbhandari, Sangit Manandhar, Anurag Poudyal (2025). Fearch: Search Smarter, Not Harder.
- Kris Lara, Sneha Dutt, Giorgi Gogitidze, Shadip Khadka, Rishikesh Yadav (2025). Realtor AI software suite demo.
- Christian Severin, Anish Thapa Magar, Nathan Ayele, Sujan Thapa (2025). PlayCards: Software Engineering Capstone Project Showcase.
- Nathan Ayele (2024). The Usage of New AI Technologies by College Students and its Influence on Learning and Dependence.
- Nika Gedenidze (2024). A Layer-Freezing Approach for Reduced Backpropagation Demand.
- Giorgi Gogitidze (2024). Using a GPT with Reinforcement Learning for More Personalized or Targeted Text Generation.
- Shadip Khadka and Khagendra Khatri (2024). ML for Plagiarism Detection in Coding Assignment.
- Vidur Khanal (2024). GoFlux: A High-Throughput Machine Learning Operations Framework.
- Shovan Raut (2024). Enhancing Mobility and Environmental Awareness for the Visually Impaired Through Real-Time Video to Audio Translation Technology.

- Jannice Salazar (2024). Comparing Touch-Based Coding to Traditional Computer Programming Methods.
- Anish Thapa Magar and Apekshya Bhattarai (2024). Touch Based Coding IDE For Smartphones.
- Rishikesh Yadav (2024). soraX: The Next Generation of AI.
- Nathan Ayele (2023). A Touch-based Approach to Programming.
- Nika Gedenidze (2023). Backpropagation is expensive. Is it necessary?
- Giorgi Gogitidze (2023). Machine Learning model in the Technical Analysis of the Stock Market.
- Rishikesh Yadav (2023). Transfer Learning in CNN Model without Backprop.
- Nika Gedenidze (2022). Explainable AI is Responsible AI: A survey of transparency in AI approaches.

III. Scholarship (4.5.1.1.3)

As stated in the Faculty Handbook: “Scholarship is an important criterion for evaluation as the University expects faculty members to be engaged with current and emerging trends in their disciplines as part of their continued professional growth. The criteria to be evaluated are publications, presentations to professional audiences or the general public, current research activities, grant and fellowship applications, peer reviewer activities, new course development, membership, participation and leadership in scholarly organizations and/or journals, and work as a consultant. In the fine and performing arts, major shows, performances and/or compositions as recognized by professionals in the field will serve as the equivalent of publication. Evidence of effectiveness in scholarship can include, but is not limited to, samples of published books or articles and of conference presentations, accounts of research in progress, grant and fellowship applications submitted, evidence of peer reviewer activities, new approved course proposals and syllabi, membership of and/or offices held in scholarly organizations and/or journals, evidence of work performed for conferences and scholarly organizations and of consultant work, materials from shows, performances and/or compositions in the fine and performing arts.”

Discuss and provide concrete evidence as to how you have satisfied these criteria.

Scholarship, to me, extends well beyond the traditional metrics of publications and conference presentations. While these remain important, I believe the highest purpose of scholarship at a teaching-focused institution is to create opportunities for students to grow intellectually, professionally, and personally. My scholarly activities are therefore guided by two primary goals. First, I strive to advance Computer Science through research, software development, and curriculum innovation that addresses meaningful problems in both the discipline and computer science education. Second, I seek to involve students as active collaborators throughout that process, helping them identify and develop research questions that reflect their own interests, passions, and career aspirations and providing the mentorship necessary to transform those ideas into rigorous scholarly work.

This philosophy has shaped nearly every aspect of my scholarly activity at Caldwell. It influences the curriculum I design, the research projects I pursue, the software I develop, and the structure of the laboratories I lead. Rather than asking students to contribute to a single research agenda, I encourage them to develop projects that reflect their own interests and career aspirations. As a result, students in my laboratory have investigated topics ranging from financial technology and machine learning to human-computer interaction, educational technology, health care applications, software engineering, accessibility, and AI-assisted systems. My role is to help students refine these ideas into technically rigorous projects while teaching the research, communication, and engineering skills necessary to bring them to completion.

I also view curriculum development as an important form of scholarship. Computer Science is among the fastest-evolving academic disciplines, and our responsibility as educators extends beyond teaching existing material—we must continually evaluate how the discipline is changing and redesign curricula to ensure that students graduate with knowledge and skills that remain relevant. This perspective has guided my efforts to modernize the Computer Science curriculum, develop new interdisciplinary programs, increase flexibility through elective pathways, and introduce emerging topics such as artificial intelligence, full-stack web development, and human-computer interaction. My goal has never been simply to add new courses, but to create a curriculum that allows students with diverse interests to pursue meaningful and individualized educational paths.

My own research has likewise evolved in response to the educational challenges I encounter in the classroom. While my earlier work focused primarily on cognitive modeling, artificial intelligence, and human-computer interaction, many of my recent projects investigate questions arising directly from teaching Computer Science. These include developing more effective approaches to academic integrity, designing software that improves student learning and assessment, exploring technologies that make programming instruction more accessible, and studying how AI can be integrated responsibly into Computer Science education. I find this intersection of research and teaching particularly rewarding because improvements resulting from these projects immediately benefit my own students while contributing knowledge that helps educators and students beyond Caldwell.

Since joining the Caldwell University faculty in January 2022, I have maintained an active and productive research agenda that aligns with the above-stated philosophy and the University's expectation for faculty engagement with emerging trends in Computer Science. My scholarship is multifaceted, encompassing curriculum development, original research in Artificial Intelligence and Human-Computer Interaction, the development of innovative educational and research software, significant grant acquisition efforts, and consistent publication and presentation of my work at professional conferences. This commitment to scholarship not only facilitates my own professional growth but also directly enhances the academic environment for my students, providing them with opportunities to participate in cutting-edge research and work with modern technological tools.

My scholarship and rigorous research program were recognized by the University, culminating in the prestigious award and my appointment as the **Alvin R. Calman Endowed Chair** in May 2025.

- Curriculum Development
 - Major contributor on a proposal for MS in Computer Science graduate program at Caldwell University
 - Contributed to developing a new STEM MBA graduate program at Caldwell University
 - Redesigned Computer Science major
 - Updated the major to modernize it and tailor it to Caldwell student population, adding more flexibility in concentration, adding emphasis on modern software development (especially full-stack web development), and removing legacy requirements (e.g., Calculus)
 - Redesigned Computer Programming I and II, Front-End and Full-stack development courses
 - Modernized introductory programming courses around Python as an industry standard development language, widely considered to be the best language for new programmers
 - Modernized Front-End and Full-stack development courses to reflect modern web architecture (e.g., Express, REST, JSON, NoSQL)
 - Developed new multidisciplinary minor – Human-Computer Interaction
 - An interdisciplinary curriculum that bridges computer science and psychology, equipping students with user-centric design skills essential for modern UX/UI career paths.
 - Developed new undergraduate courses –
 - CS 150 AI Essentials
 - Focuses on AI fluency and a "human-in-the-loop" philosophy, training students to audit AI outputs and integrate automation ethically, ensuring they are prepared for an AI-driven workforce.
 - CS 242 UI/UX Human-centered design
 - Emphasizes industry-standard tools like Figma and user-centric evaluation methodologies, directly mirroring professional design processes to enhance career readiness.
 - CS 415 Computational Models and Simulations
 - Provides critical exposure to real-world behavioral modeling and data science techniques, preparing students for high-demand roles in analytics and AI strategy.
 - CS 197 Computer Programming Accelerated
 - Designed to accelerate technical proficiency, facilitating a faster, more effective transition to advanced coursework and internships by streamlining introductory programming sequences.
 - CS 491/492 Research in Computer Science I/II

- Fosters professional development through original research, peer-reviewed publication, and conference presentation, positioning students as highly competitive candidates for graduate programs and research-intensive careers.
- Developed new graduate courses –
 - Machine Learning, AI Engineering and Generative Systems, Programming for Business, Leveraging Artificial Intelligence for Competitive Advantage, Computational Models & Simulations
 - Courses were developed as a part of new STEM MBA and MS in Computer Science program proposals.
- Major Research Projects
 - User Interface object-Notation Language (UINL)
 - Research focuses on developing an alternative to HTML as a machine-readable spec for declaring UI elements and recording UI interactions
 - The significance of this work is that it has the potential to 1) enable platform and language independent GUI application development, 2) enable near-identical access to GUI-based software for both AI and human users, and 3) standardize user-software interaction recording and playback
 - Improving Neural Network Training Efficiency
 - Research focuses on finding alternatives to backpropagation (which is the default learning mechanism in neural networks, but it is extremely resource-intensive and not biologically realistic) for learning
 - The significance of this work is that it has the potential to greatly improve the speed of training AI models, decreasing computational and monetary costs of building AI, and decreasing the electricity needs and environmental impact of this technology
 - Touch-based IDE
 - Research focuses on developing a tap-based alternative to text-based and drag-and-drop programming languages
 - The significance of this work is that it has the potential to provide access to computer programming to a wider audience, given that 1) block-based coding is easier to learn than text-based coding, and 2) touch-based coding is focused on bringing app development to the most popular personal computing device – the smartphone
 - Plagiarism Detection
 - Research focuses on detecting plagiarism in computer programming assignments based on patterns in cursor position, text insertion, and time data
 - The significance of this work is that it has the potential to enable instructors to more easily detect cheating and to streamline coding assignments
 - Computer Science Exam Software
 - Applied research; Focuses on improving usability of coding exams with unit-tests

- The significance of this work is that it has the potential to enable instructors to more easily assess student coding abilities at scale
- Research Laboratory Foundation
 - CogAI Computer Science Research Laboratory
 - Founder and director of the CogAI research laboratory
 - Focus on Artificial Intelligence and Human-Computer Interaction research
 - Advising 5-10 undergraduate researchers every semester, up to 18 students in the summers
 - Developed a website (<https://sites.google.com/caldwell.edu/cogai>), secured physical lab space
 - C-STEM Laboratories (formerly icQR)
 - Led the effort to establish an interdisciplinary research center for computational research
 - Co-founded the center with professors from Psychology (Dr. Tsoi) and Biology (Dr. McGuinness)
 - Expanded the center to include Caldwell Robotics, CougarDevs Incubator, and more faculty research labs:
 - CyGraph Lab CyGraph Lab, headed by Dr. Sushil Poudel – a multidisciplinary research lab dedicated to advancing the frontiers of cybersecurity through cutting-edge research in EV ecosystem security, graph-based machine learning, threat intelligence, and transformer-based malware analysis
 - Bio-MED Lab, headed by Dr. Héctor G. Loyola Irizarry – a dedicated research group that uses computational tools to study microbiology and human health, such as the gut microbiome’s role in disease. The group also researches how research and mentoring shape biology students’ career development.
 - Yang Lab, headed by Yanxing Yang – investigates complex systems at the intersection of physics, biology, and materials science using both computational and experimental methods
 - NeuroBioImpact Research Lab, headed by Dr. Maria Agapito – focuses to advance integrated STEM research, with a special emphasis on health disparities and fostering discoveries that improve human health and strengthen community resilience
 - Developed and maintained the C-STEM website (<https://sites.google.com/caldwell.edu/cstem>)
 - Secured physical lab space, secured funding for high-performance computers and multiple laptop docking stations
 - CougarDevs Incubator
 - Founded an incubator program for entrepreneurial students to develop innovative apps and products
 - Developed website, legal agreement, recruited students
 - MakerSpace
 - Worked with the Art department to set up a physical space for woodwork
 - Secured funding to purchase a CNC router

- Worked with Robotics club to set up the space and secure equipment funding, organize robotics competition
- Grant Proposals
 - 2025-2026
 - CO-PI: Bioinformatics in the Age of AI: Preparing Students for the Modern Research Workforce
 - NSF IUSE- Engaged Student Learning: Level I
 - Prepared and submitted proposal
 - PI: Empowering Undergraduate Research Through Coordinated Interdisciplinary STEM Infrastructure and Outreach
 - Independent College Fund of New Jersey Pfizer Undergraduate Research Endeavors (PURE) Grant
 - Prepared and submitted proposal Dec 2025
 - Proposal for new equipment and services for C-STEM laboratories from Caldwell University HSI-STEM grant
 - Funded for \$25,000 (\$20,000 for workstations, \$5,000 for HVAC in the Robotics lab; VIS205)
 - Senior Advisor: NSF S-STEM grant with Prof. Sushil Poudel as the PI
 - Aided in securing HSI-STEM grant funding for the Bloomberg laboratory workstation upgrades in Werner, and for mini cyber-range (to be placed in RAY205 or RAY207).
 - PI: Exemplary Pathways to STEM Graduate Education
 - Proposal in progress
 - Explored partnerships with Essex County Community College and Fairleigh Dickinson University
 - Worked on letter of intent, budget
 - PI: Faculty Development Grant for funding an intercollegiate coding competition at Caldwell
 - Grant awarded (\$2,000), but had to withdraw candidacy due to event scheduling issues
 - CO-PI: NSF RITEL grant proposal exploratory work
 - Incomplete; Grant work took a different direction, turned into NSF IUSE proposal.
 - Several meetings with M&Q for discussion of potential grant proposals
 - 2024-2025
 - PI: CAREER: Simplification and Standardization of Graphical User Interface Development
 - Whitepaper submitted to NSF CISE SHF program director
 - Proposal for new equipment and services for C-STEM laboratories from Caldwell University HSI-STEM grant
 - Funded for \$10,000; purchased robotics and AR/VR equipment, high-end PC's with dedicated GPU's for Machine Learning research, and VPS service for software engineering research

- PI: Booth Ferris grant proposal for Caldwell University C-STEM Laboratories expansion
- Caldwell University Renaissance Innovation Center
 - Aided in proposal preparation
- Co-PI: STEM OrbitLink: Bridging Education to Space & Biotech Careers
- Co-PI: Congressional earmarks for expanding AI, Robotics, and VR research and education capacity at Caldwell University
- 2023-2024
 - Co-PI: Seamless Human-AI Alliance via Inverse Learning and Intent Elicitation (SHALE)
 - White Paper prepared and submitted as a collaboration with Tian Lan (George Washington University), Mahdi Imani (Northeastern University), Norbou Buchler (U.S. Army Data and Analysis Center)
 - PI: Application to attend the NSF Funding the Future
 - Prepared and submitted 15-page proposal with collaboration with Katherine Solomon; proposal accepted
 - PI: Interdisciplinary Center for Quantitative Research (icQR)
 - Prepared a 2-page proposal for the Academic Affairs office to seek \$1,000,000 in funding for enhancing research and education capabilities in the fields of Artificial Intelligence, Neuroscience, Robotics, Virtual/Augmented Reality, and Human-Computer Interaction
- 2022-2023
 - Pfizer Undergraduate Research Endeavors (PURE) Grant
 - Grant awarded (\$4,000)
 - Co-PI: Augmented Cyber Cognition with Operational Learning Automation of Deployable Expertise (ACCOLADE)
 - Proposal prepared and submitted as a collaboration with the U.S. Army Data and Analysis Center PI (Dr. Norbou Buchler)
 - Funding request from STEM Advance for icQR
 - Interdisciplinary proposal with Lily Tsoi (Psychology) and Kenneth McGuinness (Biology) for lab equipment and undergraduate Research Assistant salaries
 - Funding awarded (\$14,000)
 - Faculty Development Grant
 - Interdisciplinary grant proposal with Lily Tsoi (Psychology) and Kenneth McGuinness (Biology)
 - Aided in preparation and submission of Senator Menendez Congressional Earmarks proposal for building a physical laboratory space for the Caldwell Interdisciplinary Center for Quantitative Research
 - Aided in preparation and submission of proposal for Expansion of Caldwell University's Academic Classrooms, Research Laboratories and Faculty Collaborative Spaces to Attract STEM Majors and Increase

Degree Completion in Projected Growing Fields within New Jersey's Economy

- 2021-2022
 - Aided in preparation and submission of grant proposal for 2023 Menendez Appropriations: Computer Science (CS) Research Laboratory and Virtual Reality (VR) Creation Space in the Library
- Invited talks and professional development workshops
 - Invited talk on Generative AI in Education; presented at the Assumption College for Sisters, Morris Catholic High School, Denville, NJ (2024-12-04)
 - Educational talk on the topic of adopting educational practices in the age of generative AI; presented to ACS faculty and administrative staff
 - Caldwell University AI Workshop Series (2023 – 2024)
 - Workshop series to educate Caldwell faculty and staff on the effects of Artificial Intelligence in higher education
 - Lead introductory workshop on AI in Education
 - Helped to organize and promote the workshop series
 - Artificial Intelligence in Education talk presented at the Principles Round Table for local principals and superintendents (2023-12-01)
 - Invited talk on Generative AI in Education; presented at the Lacordaire Academy, Montclair, NJ (2024-01-12)
 - Educational talk on the topic of adopting educational practices in the age of generative AI; presented to Lacordaire faculty and administrative staff
- Research and Educational Software Development & Support
 - Veksler, V. D. (2026). ReRead.js - open source JavaScript library for editing text patterns in a more readable and maintainable way than standard regular expressions, with the ability to import from and export to regular expression code; add comments and break up the pattern into multiple lines; create custom named tokens for common and/or complex patterns.
<https://rereadjs.github.io/>
- v1.0 released Apr 2026
 - Veksler, V. D. & Veksler, B. Z. (2025). LectureTest - Secure examination software with lockdown mode, real time observation, and data analysis features. Enables special question types for Computer Programming courses (coding blocks, 1D and 2D Parsons problems).
<https://lecturedot.github.io/LectureTest>
- v0.1 (beta) released Mar 2025, tested in one course (70 students)
- v0.1 tested across 5 sections with 3 instructors
- v0.2 released Apr 2026
(140+ users registered)
 - Veksler, V. D. (2024). LectureAssign - Visual Studio Code extension aimed at preventing plagiarism and streamlining programming assignment creation and submission for Computer Science courses.
<https://marketplace.visualstudio.com/items?itemName=LectureDot.lecture-assign>
- v0.1 (beta) released Jan 2024, tested in one course
- v0.2 released Aug 2024, tested with two faculty across several sections
(200+ installs on VSCode marketplace)

- Veksler, V. D. (2023). LectureSeats - web application aimed at fast attendance taking with multi-factor proof of attendance (QR or passcode, geolocation, photo, seat code).
<https://caldwelllectureseats.github.io/>
 - v0.1 (beta) released Aug 2023, tested in four courses
 - v0.2 released Jan 2024, currently being used by multiple faculty members at Caldwell University in Business, Psychology, and Computer Science
 - v1.0 release in Aug 2025.
(500+ users registered)
- Veksler, V. D. (2023). u1js - front-end JavaScript library for cross-language cross-protocol widget display and event capture using the UINL user-interface language.
<https://uinl.github.io/u1js/>
 - v0.1 (beta) released Mar 2023
- Peer Reviewed Papers/Presentations during my time at Caldwell
 - Veksler, V. D. (2026). ReRead Text Pattern Editor for Open-Ended and Coding Questions. *Journal of Computing Sciences in Colleges*, 41(8), 273-280.
 - G., Jinlei, F., Yujie, & Veksler, V. D. (2026). Hybrid-Line Remanufacturing Process Optimization for Multi-Type Factories with Twin Delayed Deep Deterministic Policy Gradient Algorithm. *International Journal of Artificial Intelligence and Green Manufacturing (IJAIGM)*, 2(1).
 - Poudel, S. & Veksler, V. D. (2026). Beyond Accuracy: A LIME-Based Comparative Analysis of Custom CNN and Pretrained ResNet50 for Lung Cancer CT Classification. 30th annual conference of the Consortium for Computing Sciences in Colleges, Northeastern Region (CCSCNE). Northampton, MA.
 - Regmi, S., & Veksler, V. D. (2026). Facial Expression Recognition and Response with Tension Mapping and LLM-Assisted Dialogue. 30th annual conference of the Consortium for Computing Sciences in Colleges, Northeastern Region (CCSCNE). Northampton, MA.
 - Khadka, A., & Veksler, V. D. (2026). Robo-Advisors and the Investor Experience. 30th annual conference of the Consortium for Computing Sciences in Colleges, Northeastern Region (CCSCNE). Northampton, MA.
 - Veksler, V. D., Veksler, B. Z., & Khadka, A. (2025). Plagiarism Detection and Deterrence Using Behavioral Tracking. *Journal of Computing Sciences in Colleges*, 41(3), 289-303.
 - Thapa, K., Adhikari, D., & Veksler, V. D. (2025). Evaluating LMS Usability and Accessibility for Students and Instructors. 41st annual conference of the Consortium for Computing Sciences in Colleges, Eastern Region (CCSC Eastern). Glenside, PA.
 - Maharjan, K. & Veksler, V. D. (2025). Detecting Plagiarism through Visualization of Coding Activity Logs. 41st annual conference of the Consortium for Computing Sciences in Colleges, Eastern Region (CCSC Eastern). Glenside, PA.

- Mensah, P. & Veksler, V. D. (2025). A Comparative Analysis of UINL and HTML/CSS for Web Application. 29th annual conference of the Consortium for Computing Sciences in Colleges, Northeastern Region (CCSCNE). Brockport, NY.
- Sharma, K. & Veksler, V. D. (2025). Plagiarism detection in Computer Programming assignments using behavior tracking. 29th annual conference of the Consortium for Computing Sciences in Colleges, Northeastern Region (CCSCNE). Brockport, NY.
- Veksler, V. D. (2024). Artificial Intelligence in Education. Presented as a part of Caldwell University AI Workshop Series. Caldwell, NJ.
- Gedenidze, N. & Veksler, V. D. (2024). A Layer-Freezing Approach for Reduced Backpropagation Demand. 28th annual conference of the Consortium for Computing Sciences in Colleges, Northeastern Region (CCSCNE). Albany, NY.
- Salazar, J. & Veksler, V. D. (2024). Comparing Touch-Based Coding to Traditional Computer Programming Methods. 28th annual conference of the Consortium for Computing Sciences in Colleges, Northeastern Region (CCSCNE). Albany, NY.
- Khatri, K., Khadka, S., & Veksler, V. D. (2024). ML for Plagiarism Detection in Coding Assignments. 28th annual conference of the Consortium for Computing Sciences in Colleges, Northeastern Region (CCSCNE). Albany, NY.
- Gogitidze, G. & Veksler, V. D. (2024). Using a GPT with Reinforcement Learning for More Personalized or Targeted Text Generation. 28th annual conference of the Consortium for Computing Sciences in Colleges, Northeastern Region (CCSCNE). Albany, NY.
- Cassenti, D. N., Veksler, V. D., & Ritter, F. E. (2023). Editor's Review and Introduction: Cognition-Inspired Artificial Intelligence. Topics in Cognitive Science. <https://doi.org/10.1111/tops.12622>
- Veksler, V. D., Gedenidze, N. & Yadav R. (2023). Visual cortex doesn't change, why should convolutional layers? 16th International Conference on Brain Informatics (BI 2023). Hoboken, NJ.
- Gedenidze, N. & Veksler, V. D. (2023). Backpropagation is expensive. Is it necessary? 27th annual conference of the Consortium for Computing Sciences in Colleges, Northeastern Region (CCSCNE). Ithaca, NY.

IV. Service (4.5.1.1.4)

As stated in the Faculty Handbook: “The role of faculty at the university extends beyond the classroom as faculty participation in the operation of the university is important both for the effective functioning of the institution and for shared governance. Faculty are expected to participate in the governance of the university through committee work and other activities. Faculty are encouraged to be involved in the wider community both for the benefit of the community and as a way of advancing and promoting the mission of the university. The criteria to be evaluated are as follows. Expected service activities include attendance at faculty, all-campus, and department/school meetings, attendance at commencement, participation on

university committees and task forces (effective participation on one committee or task force is the minimum annual contractual obligation for all full-time faculty), and involvement in departmental/school activities such as placement testing, assessment, program review, or accreditation. Other possible service activities may include (but are not limited to), attendance at other academic functions, participation in the functioning of the Faculty Council and its committees, service as Department Chair or Associate Dean, acting as representative of the university to the larger community or participating in community service activities outside the university (community activities might be local to Caldwell, NJ or local to the community in which you live), service to the student body, service as advisor to a student organization, service as moderator of student activities, planning and/or participation in enrichment activities related to the curriculum but outside normal course offerings, and participation in orientation, testing and registration of students. Evidence of effective service can include, but is not limited to, self-assessments and feedback from committee chairs and other relevant institutional personnel.

Discuss and provide concrete evidence as to how you have satisfied these criteria.

I view service not simply as participation in university governance, but as an opportunity to build the infrastructure, programs, and collaborative relationships that enable students and faculty to succeed long after any individual initiative has concluded. Whether serving on committees, mentoring colleagues, developing new academic programs, or establishing research and teaching resources, I strive to create systems that strengthen the university and continue providing value for years to come.

Since joining Caldwell University, I have been deeply committed to the effective functioning of the institution through active participation in shared governance and ongoing institutional service. My involvement spans high-level leadership, such as co-directing the Faculty Development Committee and the Teaching & Learning Center, to vital contributions on the Institutional Review Board and various faculty search committees. Beyond internal governance, I am dedicated to advancing the university's mission through community outreach, the leadership of student organizations, and the modernization of our departmental infrastructure. I view service as a key mechanism for fostering an environment where both students and faculty can thrive, and I take pride in contributing to the operational and academic excellence of the institution.

- Committees
 - Co-director of the Faculty Development Committee (May 2024 – May 2026)
 - Led the process to announce and select Faculty Development grant and sabbatical applications
 - Aided with Faculty Development Reviews for junior faculty
 - Developed faculty surveys
 - Updated instruments for committee procedures
 - Co-director of the Teaching & Learning Center (May 2024 – May 2026)
 - Worked with Dr. Chernobilsky and Dr. Bitondo to organize and lead new faculty orientation, new adjunct orientation, adjunct institute every semester
 - Invited speaker and hosted Faculty Development lecture on gamifying education

- Co-hosted faculty development lectures on AI in education
 - Set up outline and organized faculty development events
 - Member of the Institutional Review Board (2022 - present)
 - Regular meeting attendance and contribution
 - Completed reviews for multiple proposed research projects
 - Member of the Science and Health Science Facility Committee
 - Actively initiated and contributed to discussions on constraints, technology, and desired features for construction of a new Science and Health Science building
 - Co-chair of the Dean of Arts & Sciences Search Committee (2024)
 - Co-chaired committee with Nicolette Salerno
 - Organized and lead the effort to select interview questions
 - Organized and lead the effort to interview and evaluate candidate
 - Gathered committee responses and submitted committee recommendations to the Academic Affairs and Human Resources offices
 - Member of Computer Science instructor search committee (2024)
 - Member of Graphics Design full-time faculty search committee (2024)
 - Member of Computer Science full-time faculty search committee (2023)
 - Member of Experimental Psychology faculty search committee (2023)
- Meetings, ceremony attendance, and other administrative service
 - All-faculty meetings
 - School of Business and Computer Science meetings
 - Computer Science & Information Systems Department meetings
 - Annual honors convocation attendance
 - Annual graduation attendance
 - Regular survey participation
- Other service activities
 - Liaison for teaching assistants in Computer Science (under the HSI STEM grant Undergraduate Laboratory Instructional Assistant program)
 - Recruitment and advising of instructional assistants for several introductory Computer Science courses every semester
 - Advisor of the Computer Science club
 - Helped to organize workshops, hackathon competitions
 - Advisor for the Google Developers Group
 - Helped to organize workshops, hackathon competitions
 - Advisor for the Robotics Club
 - Helped to secure space and funding, organize robotics competition
 - Encouraged and mentored students in the establishment of the Women in STEM club to foster inclusive support networks
 - Recruited leaders among female CS students to found Women in STEM at Caldwell and recommended female faculty as potential club advisors
 - Peer-tutor recruitment for Computer Science

V. Collegiality (4.5.1.1.5)

As stated in the Faculty Handbook: “The ability to work productively with faculty, administration and staff, and community representatives is important for the University in the effective fulfillment of its mission. The criteria to be evaluated are working relationships with faculty colleagues, staff, and members of the administration. Evidence for collegiality can include, but is not limited to, self-assessments, written feedback from colleagues, and the Chair/Associate Dean annual evaluation report and other feedback.”

Discuss and provide concrete evidence as to how you have satisfied these criteria.

Collegiality is the foundation of my professional practice at Caldwell University, extending beyond standard working relationships to actively facilitating the success of my colleagues. I believe institutional success is inherently collaborative; therefore, I strive to create an environment where faculty, administration, and staff can more easily pursue their teaching, scholarship, and service goals. This commitment is evidenced by my focus on interdisciplinary partnerships—such as co-founding our research centers—and my ongoing efforts to provide infrastructure and project support. By mentoring new faculty, sharing technical expertise, and collaborating closely with support staff to improve our shared resources, I aim to strengthen the university’s mission, cultivate a positive community, and foster productive relationships that ultimately benefit our students and the broader university culture.

It is difficult to recount all instances of collegiality during my time at Caldwell University, and no list will fully capture the subtle passing moments of collegial expression that I strive to integrate into my everyday interactions with colleagues. However, the list below may serve as a worthwhile sample of the types of activities that I engage in as a member of the Caldwell community:

- **Mentoring & Colleague Support**
 - Volunteer Mentor for new faculty member (Mohamed Gebril)
 - Recruited colleagues to join the interdisciplinary research center and aided them with establishing a web presence for their laboratories
 - Aided colleagues (Cagla Yildirim, Sushil Poudel, Sal Ferraro) with setting up and tracking summer research student project progress
 - Aided faculty in Finance to upgrade workstations for the Bloomberg laboratory
 - Arranged with one of my students to do a robotics presentation for prospective students during an event hosted by a colleague (Cagla Yildirim)
- **Institutional & Infrastructure Support**
 - Developed School of Business and Computer Science newsletter website (<https://sites.google.com/caldwell.edu/sobcs>; was in use from 2022 to 2025)
 - Aided in reorganization of the Computer Science book collection at the Caldwell University Library (2022)
 - Aided Library Director Victoria Swanson in an effort to add a Virtual Reality Exhibition Space to the Caldwell Library (2022)

- Consultation, research, meetings, floor design
- Governance & Curricular Dialogue
 - Ad hoc and formal discussions with Dean, Chair, and colleagues on the topics of potential school offerings, degrees, certifications, assessment, and curriculum structure in the face of the changing educational landscape in the age of AI
 - Aided in improving the First-Year Seminar via active discussions with faculty and development of new assignments aimed at career-readiness and success tracking.
 - Volunteer representative of computer science and related majors and minors at the annual Caldwell majors & minors conference.
 - Event information dissemination (career services announcements, professional events hosted by colleagues)
- Recruitment & Outreach
 - Expert Advice interview given for Computer Science students at techguide.org (2022)
 - <https://techguide.org/computer-science/bachelors-in-computer-science/#expert=vlad-veksler>
 - Promoted Caldwell University as a potential destination at regional Catholic schools
 - Lacordaire Academy
 - Morris Catholic School
 - Summit YMCA Achievement student group visit (2023-11-10)
 - Promoted Caldwell University as a potential destination for high-achieving Summit YMCA students
 - Participated in the recording of a welcome video for the 2024 incoming students
- Campus Events
 - Participated in diverse cultural celebrations to foster an inclusive campus climate, including attending a Ramadan fast break, an Eid-al-Fitr celebration, and Tihar celebrations
 - Caldwell Research and Creative Arts day volunteer faculty judge (2022 – present)
 - Caldwell Hackathon coding competition volunteer faculty judge (2023)